

August 20, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Keitha Turner (MRN MUSC5870574), Claim MUSC-6CD1-2

Patient	Keitha Turner (DOB 2004-07-22)
MRN	MUSC5870574
Member ID / Group	AMB999437436 / GRP-60820
Claim number	MUSC-6CD1-2
Date of service	2026-07-12
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$511.02
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2026-11-02

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of Keitha Turner (Member ID: AMB999437436) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-6CD1-2 for services rendered on July 12, 2026, at MUSC Health Ashley River Tower. The claim was denied under CARC 197 ("Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent") and RARC N54 ("Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services"), with the payer remark stating: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full reimbursement of the billed amount of \$511.02 for CPT code 99214, an established outpatient office visit of moderate complexity.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turner is a 22-year-old established patient who presented on July 12, 2026, at the on-campus outpatient facility (Place of Service 22) for evaluation and management of an acute upper respiratory infection (ICD-10: J06.9). The visit was conducted by Amara J. Boone, NP (NPI 1203948576) and was billed as a single unit of CPT 99214, reflecting a moderate-complexity evaluation and management service for an established patient. Ms. Turner's medical history is notable for recurrent episodes of acute viral pharyngitis, a documented shrimp IgE elevation, active prescriptions including an epinephrine auto-injector and fexofenadine, and a prior course of subcutaneous immunotherapy, all of which underscore her status as an established patient with an ongoing clinical relationship at this facility. The July 12, 2026 encounter falls within her active coverage period under the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care Advantage plan (coverage period: 2024-01-01 to 2026-12-31).

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of this claim on prior authorization grounds is not consistent with standard payer practice for routine outpatient evaluation and management services. CPT 99214 is a widely recognized evaluation and management code for established outpatient patients and, under the vast majority of commercial and Marketplace plan benefit structures, does not require prior authorization when rendered in an outpatient setting for an acute, non-elective condition such as an upper respiratory infection. Acute upper respiratory infections by their nature require timely clinical assessment and do not lend themselves to prospective authorization workflows. Requiring prior authorization for this category of service would create a barrier to medically necessary, time-sensitive care in a manner inconsistent with both the patient's plan benefits and generally accepted managed care standards.

Furthermore, RARC N54 indicates that the claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified or authorized services. MUSC Health respectfully notes that if Ambetter's records reflect a prior authorization associated with a different service type or date, this may represent an administrative discrepancy rather than a true absence of coverage eligibility. We request that Ambetter conduct a thorough review of Ms. Turner's benefit structure to confirm whether prior authorization is, in fact, a contractual requirement for outpatient established-patient E&M; services under her specific plan, and if so, to identify any applicable waiver provisions for urgent or acute presentations.

MUSC Health is prepared to provide any additional clinical documentation, including the encounter record for the July 12, 2026 visit, upon request through the secure provider portal.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-6CD1-2 and process the claim for payment in accordance with Ms. Turner's contracted plan benefits. The allowed amount on file is \$313.53, and we request that payment be issued accordingly, or that the claim be reprocessed at the applicable contracted rate if a different amount applies. Should Ambetter determine that additional information is required to complete this review, we ask that a specific written request be submitted through the secure provider portal prior to the appeal deadline of November 2, 2026, so that MUSC Health may respond in a timely manner.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)

- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record